



OPEN CALL NWA CITIZEN SCIENCE

The deadline for citizen collectives to submit ideas through Citizen Science Netherlands has now passed. The next stage is aimed at researchers. Researchers are invited to submit an **Expression of Interest (maximum one page)** for a citizen science project that aligns with the **NWA Route: Towards Resilient Societies**.

Researchers can apply:

- together with a citizen collective they are already collaborating with; or
- independently, even if they do not yet have a citizen collective partner. Where possible, the route will facilitate connections between researchers and citizen collectives.



The route can nominate up to **two proposals** to the Dutch Research Council (NWO). It is expected that **one proposal** from this route will ultimately receive funding through the NWA Citizen Science 2026 call.

Key dates

- **3 July 2026** – Deadline for submitting an Expression of Interest to the route
- **10 July 2026** – Selection results announced
- **17 September 2026 (14:00 CEST)** – Deadline for the full proposal to NWO

More information about the eligibility requirements, selection procedure and how proposals should align with the route's three "gamechangers" can be found in [the call document on LinkedIn](#). More information about the route's three gamechangers is available [here](#).

Questions? Contact the route via [LinkedIn](#) or email e.bembom@rug.nl.

DONDERS OPEN RESEARCH OUTPUT AWARD

The first-ever **Donders Open Research Output (DORO) Award** recognised outstanding contributions to open science. With this prize, the institute highlights research output that is openly shared, FAIR, and genuinely useful to the wider community, from software to data to tools that help others move their work forward.

This year's inaugural award was presented to **Margely Cornelissen** and **Julian Kosciessa** for maintaining open research software for transcranial ultrasound stimulation. The personalised simulation software **PRESTUS** and **open-source hardware interfaces** enable rigorous planning, implementation, and reporting of non-invasive ultrasound research.

The software, which was co-developed at an earlier stage by former Donders staff members Andrey Chetverikov and Stein Fekkes, has been praised for its high-quality, FAIR-compliant code, robust documentation and practical impact, and offers an open-source alternative to commercial tools. "This openness has even inspired industrial partners to share their own tools," the committee notes.

Does your institution have similar open science awards or initiatives? Please let us know, so we can highlight and share them within the OSCN community!

EVALUATION: OPEN SCIENCE NL STRENGTHENS LEADERSHIP



Open Science NL has been recognised as a leading international programme for Open Science following its first independent evaluation covering the period 2023–2025.

The international evaluation committee concluded that Open Science NL operates in a relevant, coherent, efficient, and effective manner, praising the progress achieved in less than three years since its establishment

in 2023. The committee described Open Science NL as a unique programme that could serve as a model for other European countries and noted that its success has helped position the Netherlands as an international leader in Open Science. Open Science NL was established as a national programme within NWO to accelerate the transition to open science through funding, community support, capacity building, and infrastructure development.

The evaluation highlighted the programme's broad approach, including investments in infrastructure, community building, and recognition and rewards. Strong collaboration between researchers, knowledge institutions, libraries, research funders, and societal partners was identified as a key strength. The committee recommends continuing the current course while building on the knowledge, networks, and momentum developed so far.

At the same time, the evaluators emphasised that sustained investment and collaboration will be needed to ensure the long-term embedding of Open Science practices beyond 2031. NWO has welcomed the findings and confirmed its continued commitment, together with its partners, to further strengthening and embedding Open Science in the Netherlands.

The full evaluation article, including the NWO Board Response to the Open Science Evaluation Report (PDF), is available via the [NWO website](#).

NEWS FLASHES

- We are currently working behind the scenes on the organisation of several events taking place during **National Open Science Week** this September (week 38, 14-18 Sept). More information will be shared soon!
- As we approach the end of June, the OSCN team would like to wish our community an enjoyable and relaxing break. Enjoy the summer, and we look forward to seeing you again after the holidays! ✨



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